

<http://www.learnerstv.com>

- Videos on a variety of subjects, along with illustrative animations and interactive tests

<http://oyc.yale.edu/>

- Creative commons lectures from Yale, on everything from Economics, to Bio-medical engineering to Music

<http://academicearth.org/>

- Consolidated video courses, in multiple formats from a number of institutions including MIT, Stanford and Yale

<http://freevideolectures.com/>

- Downloadable lectures from a wide range of sources, including IITs and IISc in India

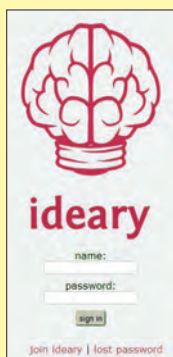
Professionals

As we did with the students, we spoke to as many professionals, from as varied verticals as possible, to try and find common problems, and innovative ways that people have found to circumvent those problems.

Problem: Staying relevant and updated

Solution: In any professional setup it's important to keep up-to-date with current events, happenings, and industry news. Apart from subscribing to your favourite RSS feeds, you can set up your own customised Start Pages. These are dynamic web pages that bring various

Stash away those ideas for later



Thought Dumbledore's pensive was a neat idea? Well there are real life digital versions of it online. The moment you get an idea, you meet someone, or just have a random stray thought that you wish to hold on to, simply head over to one of these sites and save it for ever. Both sites fea-

ture search so your ideas will not get lost. www.ideary.ru – the slightly more simple jazzy looking option. Features an idea cloud. lessmemories.com – has facility to make entries public hence you can connect with others with similar thoughts.

elements such as search, gadgets, relevant news, and lots more on a single location. Although a lot of people use iGoogle, we prefer Netvibes.com. It's probably the best there is in terms of productive content and looks. Netvibes is able to aggregate your email too, so you rarely need to leave the page. If you want to explore options, you can also check out Pageflakes.com and Webwag.com. The best part about a start page is that you can sign in from any computer in the world, and all your customisation stays intact.

Social news aggregators also function brilliantly to keep a stream of relevant information flowing to you. Popurls.com is by far the coolest and most informative service out there. You can customise it further to cut through the silly stuff to only get the kind of news you want. Check out megite.com and web20.originalsignal.com for more options.

Problem: Group brainstorming across locations

Solution: There's just something about a whiteboard that adds to creativity. Some of the most brilliant ideas emerge when a group of people come together and scribble away to glory on a whiteboard. Hence we have digital whiteboards such as Dabbleboard.com that

More instant whiteboards

Each of these provides a unique feature or two. Choose the one that fits your team the best. Scribbler.com – Room type of set up Twiddla.com – Rather nice looking environment Imaginationcubed.com – A tool from GE, features a 3D marker and a nice playback option

provide an interactive whiteboarding environment. Simply share the URL and you and your team can begin collaborating. No sign-ups necessary.

Problem: Standing out in the crowd

Solution: Part of succeeding at your job is to collaborate well, as we illustrated with the whiteboard example. However, an even bigger secret to success is to make sure you are noticed, and can come up with solutions that help your company. This usually comes from being able to stay relevant and updated, and also requires a little out of the box thinking. Sneha Patel, a junior designer at a Mumbai graphics studio was looking at getting some millage with colleagues and superiors. On a lark she got some colleagues on to plum.com – a closed group version of twitter. Counterproductive? Not really. "My colleagues and I were able to share realtime updates and that actually increased productivity and teamwork" she says. More importantly she got noticed. Moral of the story be on the lookout for innovative online services

that can be put to use in the corporate world, and soon enough you'll be known as the ideas man (or woman in this case) of your office. Psst. Get your IT guy to setup status.net or better yet, start your own corporate networks on twingr.com, presently, or even yammer.com if your company doesn't already have one.

Problem: Grow personally

Solution: There are small ways in which you can value add to your skill set using technology. Wordweb is a small thesaurus cum dictionary app that sits in your task bar, ready to be invoked anytime a fractious word comes your way. Highlight a word in any

It's all about presentation...

It's a well known fact that a good idea not presented well can really tank. To enhance your presentations, blog posts, or just about anything that can be represented graphically you can use online resources. Head over to these web sites to create nice looking charts that require only one step in most cases:

www.chartgo.com
Easy to use and simple.

www.diychart.com
Stunning examples available, that can be modified.

www.charts.hohli.com
Charts made with the Google Charts API.